

THE UNIVERSITY OF GHANA



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ASSIGNMENT 2

**CLIENT INTERVIEW EVIDENCE AND REQUIREMENT TRANSFORMATION
MEMO**

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INDEX NUMBER: 22304024

TEAM NAME: SThrive

PROJECT TITLE: SThrive Network

PROGRAMME: COMPUTER SCIENCE

COURSE: SOFTWARE ENGINEERING (DCIT 208)

LECTURER: PROFESSOR MARK ATTA-MENSAH

INDIVIDUAL GITHUB PORTFOLIO: <https://github.com/Adom-Asare>

GROUP GITHUB PORTFOLIO: <https://github.com/Dept-of-Comp-Sci-University-of-Ghana/dcit208-client-project-2026-team-engineering-repository-sthrive/tree/main>

DATE: 01-07-26

A. Personal Question Set (Pre-Interview)

These questions were prepared before the client meeting to guide the discovery session. They are organized to satisfy the required categories.

Current Workflow (x2)

1. How does someone currently become a member of She Thrives Network — what actually happens, step by step, from first hearing about the organization to being fully onboarded?
2. How do you currently announce and manage events across the organization, and how do members find out about upcoming sessions?

Pain Points (x2) 3. What aspects of managing your current membership process take the most time or create the most room for error? 4. Where does your current approach struggle most when trying to scale — for example, reaching all members at once or tracking who has paid for what?

Data (x2) 5. What information do you currently collect about a member when they join — name, email, profession, anything else? 6. How are subscriptions or payments, if any, currently tracked and managed within the organization?

Success Criteria (x2) 7. What would make this platform feel like a genuine success for She Thrives Network six months after launch? 8. What does a typical active member's weekly interaction with the platform look like, if everything is working well?

Security/Privacy (x1) 9. Does the organization currently have a safeguarding or data protection policy that the platform should align with?

Failure/Exception Handling (x1) 10. What happens when something goes wrong — for example, if a member joins but never engages, or if someone inappropriate gains access to the community? Is there a current process for handling that?

Additional (to reach 12) 11. What subscription tiers are you envisioning, and what would actually differentiate a free member's experience from a premium member's? 12. Who within the organization should have the ability to create or approve content on the platform — is that strictly leadership, or can members contribute?

B. Interview/Observation Evidence

Date: 26 June 2026 **Time:** 12:06 PM (Ghana time) **Duration:** Approximately 20 minutes
Medium: Online video call (recorded) **Participant:** Dr. Kinsella— She Thrives Network team member; member of the events/operations side of the organization; herself a medical professional within the network **Evidence type:** Recorded meeting transcript (auto-transcribed) **Private information:** No personal contact details, addresses, or sensitive member data discussed. Participant name retained as it was provided in the professional context of the meeting.

Summary of what happened:

The session was a structured client discovery call conducted by Adom Asare (PM/backend engineer, SThrive team) with Dr. Kinsella of She Thrives Network. The first few minutes were spent resolving audio issues before the substantive interview began. The following key findings emerged:

On membership and onboarding: Membership is open to the public — not restricted by invite. The organization targets professionals and students but does not gatekeep formally. New members are typically introduced through events (virtual or in-person) or via social media, after which they are added to a WhatsApp group or given a link to join one. There is no formal digital onboarding system.

On gender verification: There is currently no process to verify whether new members are women. The client noted that this has not been a problem in practice — the community has not experienced any known instances of bad actors joining under false pretences.

On subscription plans: The organization intends to introduce a tiered subscription model but has not finalized the structure. The client described a vision where a basic/free plan gives access to event information and general motivational content, while a premium plan would give access to the network's professionals (doctors, lawyers, counselors, IT specialists, mental health specialists, social workers). Monetizing mentorship is also part of the vision — Pastor Christa currently provides personal mentorship through her PA on a paid basis, and the organization wants to scale this more broadly. Final tier decisions are pending discussion with the visionary leader, Pastor Christa Afful.

On events: Events are created exclusively by leadership — members cannot create events independently. Members can suggest events, but they would be organized and owned by She Thrives Network. The organization plans events annually, both in-person (targeted at the Thrive League, a professional sub-group within She Thrives Network) and virtual (open to She Thrives Network and the public). Current announcement channels include WhatsApp, Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, Eventbrite, church announcements, and word of mouth.

On content: Content creation goes through the leadership/events team before anything is published. Members can contribute ideas or material, but it must align with the organization's vision and be approved before going live.

On safeguarding: The organization follows the UK national safeguarding guidelines. No specific training is required since they do not work directly with children. They have professionals on the team (including people who work for local councils) who are equipped to handle any safeguarding concerns if raised.

On mentorship: Mentorship has not been officially launched. Currently it happens informally — someone expresses interest and is manually connected to an appropriate professional. The client confirmed this is an area they want to formalize and monetize through the subscription model.

C. Requirement Transformation

Raw client statement selected:

"If someone subscribes to a basic plan, right, they probably would just have access to maybe information about events and, you know, general sort of motivational messages that we share on our page. But if you're subscribing to something like maybe a premium plan, you have access to certain professionals or all the professionals. So we have lawyers, and we have counselors, doctors, like I said, we have IT specialists, social workers, mental health specialists." — Dr. Kinsella, 26 June 2026

Functional Requirement: The system shall implement a tiered membership model where Basic/Free tier members can access event listings and general content (announcements, motivational messages), while Premium tier members can additionally access professional member profiles and submit consultation requests to professionals in the network (doctors, lawyers, counselors, IT specialists, mental health specialists, social workers).

Non-Functional Requirement: The platform shall enforce tier-based access control consistently across all pages and API endpoints, ensuring that premium-restricted resources are inaccessible to non-premium members regardless of how the request is made (browser navigation, direct API call, or URL guessing), with access decisions resolved within 100ms of authentication.

User Story: As a Premium-tier member of She Thrives Network, I want to browse and connect with verified professionals in the network so that I can access expert guidance relevant to my career, health, finances, or personal growth.

Acceptance Criteria (Given/When/Then):

1. Given a Free-tier member is logged in, when they navigate to the professional directory, then they see a restricted preview with a prompt to upgrade their subscription — not an error page or blank screen.
2. Given a Premium-tier member is logged in, when they search the professional directory by specialty, then they can view full profiles of all available professionals in that category.
3. Given a Premium-tier member views a professional's profile, when they submit a consultation request, then they receive confirmation that the request has been sent and the professional is notified.
4. Given an admin is logged in, when they manage member tiers, then they can manually upgrade or downgrade any member's tier, and the change takes effect on the member's next action without requiring them to log out and back in.

5. Given a member's subscription lapses or is cancelled, when they next make a request to a premium-gated endpoint, then their access is immediately reverted to the appropriate tier and they receive a clear message explaining why access is restricted.

API/Interface Implication: A GET /api/professionals endpoint will need to check the authenticated user's tier before returning full profile data versus a limited preview. A POST /api/consultations/request endpoint will require tier-validation middleware that runs before the controller. A PATCH /api/admin/members/:id/tier endpoint will be needed for admin tier management.

Data Implication: The User schema requires a tier field (enum: ['free', 'premium', 'elite']) and, for members who are professionals, an optional professionalProfile sub-document containing their specialty, bio, consultation availability, and professional credentials. A separate ConsultationRequest collection will be needed, linking requesting member to professional with a status field (enum: ['pending', 'accepted', 'declined', 'completed']) and timestamps.

Test Idea: Test that a Free-tier authenticated user making a GET /api/professionals/:id/full request receives a 403 Forbidden response with a descriptive message. Verify that the exact same request made with a Premium-tier token returns the full professional profile data. Both tests should be run against the same endpoint to confirm the access decision is being made server-side and not merely hidden on the frontend.

Open Question: How does a member declare that they are a professional when joining? Is this self-declared at registration, assigned manually by an admin, or subject to a verification/approval process before their professional profile is made visible to other members? The answer directly affects the onboarding flow and the admin management interface.

D. Reflection (250–350 words)

Prior to this conversation, several assumptions shaped the team's design approach. The most significant concerned how members join She Thrives Network. The team had reasoned — without direct confirmation — that onboarding was largely informal and relationship-driven: a friend brings someone to a meeting, or passes along a WhatsApp link through an existing trust network. This assumption was partially confirmed but also meaningfully revised. Dr. Kinsella confirmed that membership is genuinely open to the public — anyone who resonates with the organization's vision can join — and that events serve as the primary recruitment mechanism, with new members frequently discovering She Thrives Network through virtual or in-person sessions. The model is more open than assumed, which means the platform's registration flow can be straightforwardly self-serve, without any invite-code or referral-gate mechanism.

A second assumption that was tested was around gender verification. The team had spent real time evaluating different approaches to this — self-attestation, manual admin review, and

more complex verification mechanisms. The assumption was that this would be a nuanced policy question the client would have strong views on. In reality, the client confirmed there is no current verification process and no reported incidents of bad actors gaining access. This weakens the assumption that verification needs to be technically complex — a simple self-declaration at registration is the appropriate, client-aligned solution.

The most impactful shift in understanding came from the subscription model discussion. Before the meeting, the team had been treating tier differentiation as an abstract SaaS-style product decision — "more features for more money." The conversation revealed something far more specific: subscription tiers are tied to access to real professionals within the network (doctors, lawyers, mental health specialists) and to a mentorship scheme the organization wants to formalize and scale. This is not a generic "Pro unlocks more buttons" model — it is a professional services access model. That distinction meaningfully changes how tier-gating logic should be designed and what the premium experience actually needs to deliver.

The assumption that became weakest after this meeting: that subscription tiers were already a settled decision. They remain unconfirmed pending discussion with Pastor Christa Afful, and a follow-up meeting is needed before the team can finalize tier-gating logic.

AI Disclosure Statement

I used AI assistance. The tool used was Claude. The purpose of use was to improve clarity, organization, grammar, and formatting of my independently written insights from my meeting with Dr. Kinsella, as well as to help refine technical explanations and verify some technical terms.

Date	Tool	Prompt Summary	Output Used	Output Rejected	Verification Method
July 2026	Claude	Improve structure, grammar, and organization of request-flow explanation and verify technical concepts	Improved wording, organization, formatting, and clearer explanations	Generic assumptions unrelated to the project and any inaccurate technical suggestions	Compared with meeting Notes with Dr. Kinsella, lecture materials, and team project decisions before final inclusion

I understand that I must be able to explain and defend every part of this submission.